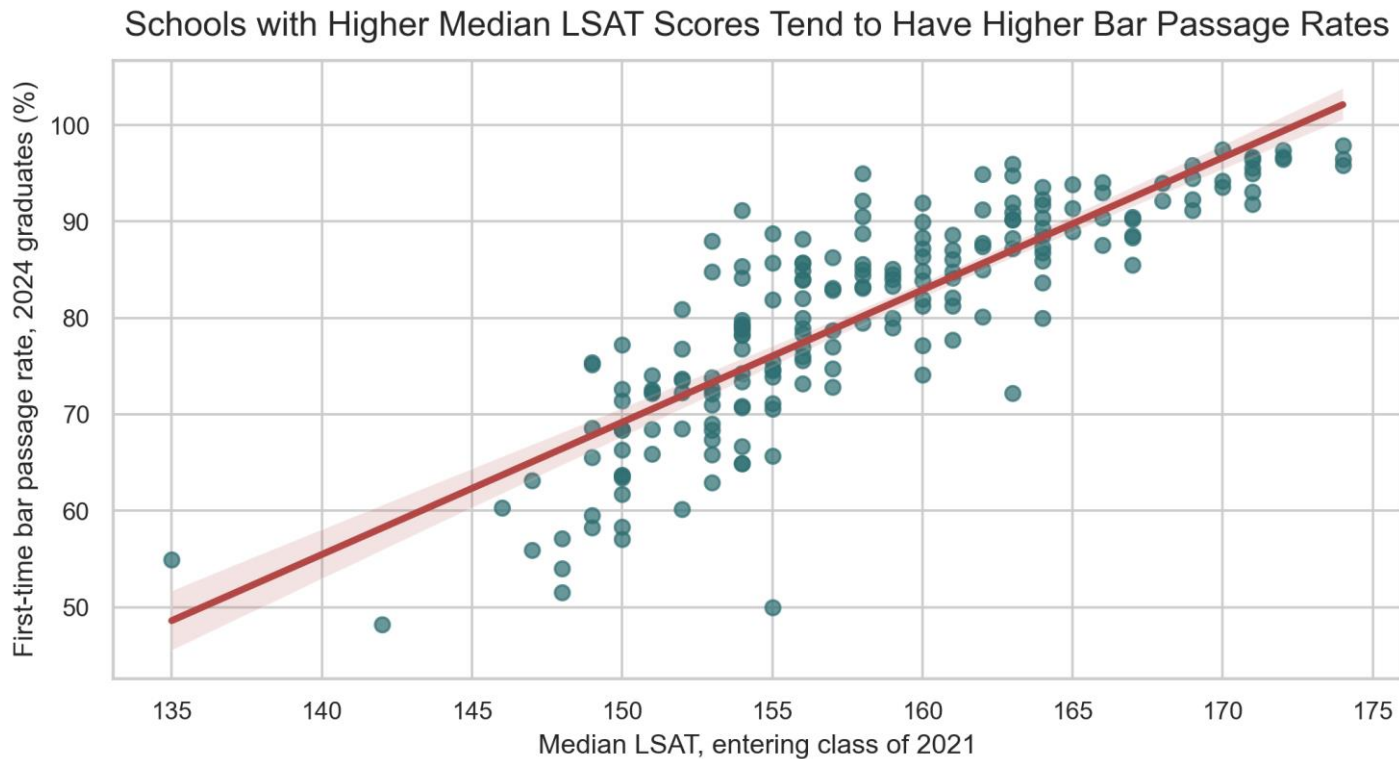


Do LSAT and GPA predict law school bar outcomes?

Research question: Do ABA-approved schools with higher 2021 entering credentials tend to have higher 2024 first-time bar passage rates?



Most compelling visualization

Each dot is one ABA-approved law school.

The upward line shows a positive school-level association.

Important: this does not prove LSAT causes bar passage.

Data summary

- ABA school-level data, N = 194
- 2021 credentials: LSAT and GPA
- Outcome: 2024 first-time bar passage
- Controls: class size, public/private, tuition

Main takeaway

Schools with higher median LSAT scores tend to have higher first-time bar passage rates.

Controlled model: the LSAT relationship stays positive

Null hypothesis: no relationship between entering credentials and first-time bar passage rate.

$$\text{Model: BarPass} = \beta_0 + \beta_1(\text{LSAT}) + \beta_2(\text{GPA}) + \beta_3(\text{ClassSize}) + \beta_4(\text{Public}) + \beta_5(\text{Tuition}) + \varepsilon$$

Variable	Model 1	Controlled Model
Median LSAT	1.37***	1.14***
Median GPA	—	12.50**
Class size	—	-0.003
Public school	—	-1.69
Tuition (\$10k)	—	-0.73
R ²	0.705	0.728
N	194	194

***p < 0.001, **p < 0.01

Conclusion

Careful answer: yes, schools with higher LSAT/GPA tend to have higher bar passage, but this is correlation only. Omitted variables and state bar difficulty matter.

Key findings

- LSAT remains positive after controls: +1.14 percentage points per LSAT point.
- GPA is also positive and statistically significant.
- Class size, public status, and tuition are not statistically significant here.

OLS check: residuals are centered near zero, but possible heteroskedasticity remains.

